11-21 第二篇

Learning from Failure: Why Mistakes Help Us Grow

Failure is something everyone experiences at some point. We fail a test, lose a game, or make a wrong decision. In many cultures, failure is seen as something shameful—something to hide or avoid. But in recent years, psychologists and educators have begun to see failure differently. They argue that failure, when we learn from it, can be one of our best teachers. [1] Changing how we think about failure can help us become more resilient, creative, and successful in the long run.

When we fail, we often discover what went wrong. A failed science experiment shows which approach does not work. A poor test result may point to topics we need to study more. In sports, losing a match can reveal weaknesses in our strategy or skills. By analyzing our failures instead of ignoring them, we gain useful information that success alone might not provide. [2] In this sense, failure gives us valuable feedback that guides us toward better choices and improved performance next time.

Some of the world's greatest inventors and leaders faced many failures before succeeding. Thomas Edison tried thousands of materials before finding the right one for the light bulb. J.K. Rowling's first Harry Potter manuscript was rejected by several publishers. These stories remind us that persistence—continuing to try despite setbacks—is often the key to eventual success. [3] Failure does not mean the end of the road; it can be a stepping stone to achievement when we refuse to give up.

A "growth mindset" is the belief that we can improve through effort and learning. People with a growth mindset see failure as a chance to get better, not as proof that they lack ability. Schools and parents can help children develop this mindset by praising effort and strategy rather than only results. When mistakes are treated as learning opportunities, children become more willing to take on challenges. [4] By embracing a growth mindset, we can turn failure from a source of fear into a source of growth and motivation.

Of course, failure can still hurt. It is natural to feel disappointed or frustrated when things do not go as planned. The important thing is not to let failure define us or stop us from trying again. We can allow ourselves to feel the emotion, then reflect on what we learned and what we might do differently. [5] When we learn to face failure with courage and curiosity, we open ourselves up to greater possibilities and a more fulfilling life.

选项

A. Changing how we think about failure can help us become more resilient, creative, and successful in the long run. B. In this sense, failure gives us valuable feedback that guides us toward better choices and improved performance next time. C. Failure does not mean

the end of the road; it can be a stepping stone to achievement when we refuse to give up. D. By embracing a growth mindset, we can turn failure from a source of fear into a source of growth and motivation. E. When we learn to face failure with courage and curiosity, we open ourselves up to greater possibilities and a more fulfilling life. F. For instance, many successful startups had to change their business plans several times after early ideas failed to attract customers.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：空前指出人人都会经历失败、文化中常将失败视为羞耻，以及心理学与教育学的新观点——失败可成为良师，空后需总结转变失败观的益处。A的"Changing how we think about failure"与前文新观点呼应，"more resilient, creative, and successful"概括后文将展开的正面效果。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：空前列举失败带来的信息——实验失败排除错误、考试暴露薄弱点、比赛揭示策略或技术短板，空后需总结失败作为反馈的价值。B的"In this sense, failure gives us valuable feedback"与前文分析失败获取信息对应，"guides us toward better choices and improved performance"概括失败对进步的引导作用。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：空前举例爱迪生、罗琳等名人屡败屡战终获成功，强调坚持的重要性，空后需总结失败与成功的关系。C的"Failure does not mean the end of the road"与前文名人经历对应，"a stepping stone to achievement when we refuse to give up"点明失败与坚持的关系。
- **[4] D**：
  - **线索**：空前介绍成长型思维——相信可通过努力进步、将失败视为改进机会，以及学校与家庭的培养方法，空后需总结思维转变的作用。D的"By embracing a growth mindset"与前文成长型思维对应，"turn failure from a source of fear into a source of growth and motivation"概括心态转变带来的改变。
- **[5] E**：
  - **线索**：空前承认失败会带来痛苦、强调不被失败定义、允许感受情绪后反思改进，空后需收束全文。E的"When we learn to face failure with courage and

curiosity"总结前文态度，"open ourselves up to greater possibilities and a more fulfilling life"是全文主题的升华收尾。

- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. For instance, many successful startups had to change their business plans several times after early ideas failed to attract customers.**：以For instance开头，为具体商业案例（创业公司）。各空均为概括或过渡句；[3]易被误选因涉及失败后成功，但该空需概括失败与坚持的普遍关系，而非创业公司改计划的个例。